



REPORT | NOVEMBER 13, 2019

EUROPE'S UNAUTHORIZED IMMIGRANT POPULATION PEAKS IN 2016,
THEN LEVELS OFF

Appendix C: Unauthorized immigrant population trends without waiting asylum seekers, by country



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Editorial note to readers (March 19, 2025):

This project estimated the number of unauthorized immigrants living in 32 European countries during the mid- to late-2010s. We used what were then the best available data sources from different governments and from the European Union. After our report was published in November 2019, researchers at the University of Oxford's Migration Observatory [identified a problem](#) with the official data from the United Kingdom's Office for National Statistics (ONS) on the number of legal immigrants residing in the UK.

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2.8 million-3.5 million for Europe. [Updated estimates can be found in this table but are not reflected elsewhere in this report.](#)

European unauthorized immigrant population estimates without waiting asylum seekers, 2014-2017

Estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in thousands by country of residence

	2017		2016		2015		2014	
	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High
Austria	--	<100	--	<100	--	100	--	<100
Belgium	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Bulgaria	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Croatia	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Cyprus	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Czech Republic	100	200	100	200	100	200	100	200
Denmark	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Estonia	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
France	200	300	300	400	200	300	200	300
Finland	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Germany	600	700	500	800	200	800	300	400
Greece	100	200	--	100	<100	100	<100	100
Hungary	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Iceland	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Ireland	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Italy	300	600	300	500	200	500	200	500
Latvia	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Liechtenstein	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Lithuania	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Luxembourg	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Malta	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Netherlands	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Norway	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Poland	--	<100	100	200	--	<100	--	<100
Portugal	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Romania	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Slovakia	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Slovenia	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Spain	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100	100	200
Sweden	--	100	--	<100	--	<100	--	<100
Switzerland	--	<100	<100	100	<100	100	--	<100
United Kingdom	800	1,200	900	1,300	800	1,200	800	1,200
Total EU-EFTA	2,900	3,800	3,000	4,200	2,300	3,800	2,400	3,200

Note: All numbers are rounded; see Methodology for rounding rules. "Low" and "High" show the range of estimates for the unauthorized immigrant population. "--" shown for "Low" estimate indicates a population estimate below 100,000.

Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force survey data.

"Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

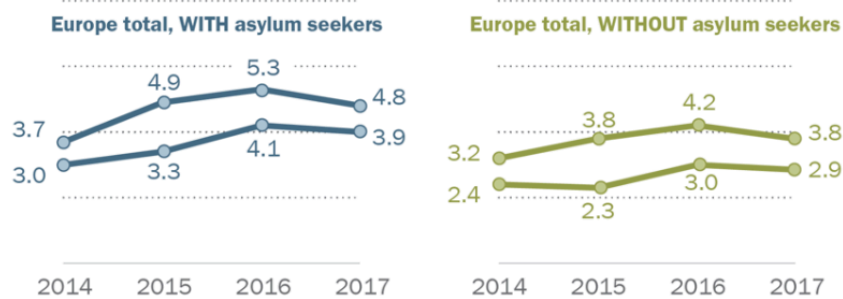
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Europe's estimated unauthorized immigrant population with and without waiting asylum seekers, 2014-2017

Range for the estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in millions living in Europe



Note: Estimates are for unauthorized immigrants living in all European Union countries (28, including the UK) and four European Free Trade Association (EU-EFTA) countries (Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland) combined. All numbers are rounded; see Methodology for rounding rules. Low and high estimates indicate the range of estimates based on various methodological approaches.

Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force data. "Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

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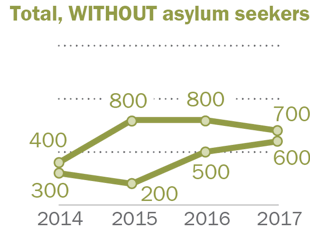
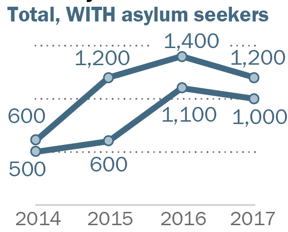
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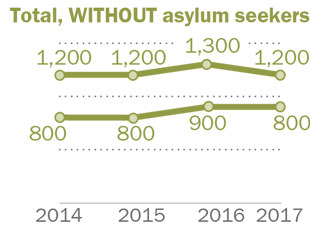
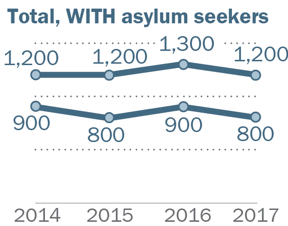
Estimated unauthorized immigrant population by country, with and without waiting asylum seekers, 2014-2017

Range for the estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in thousands by country of residence

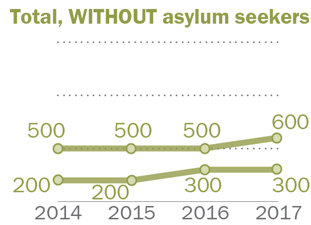
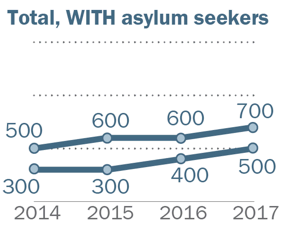
Germany



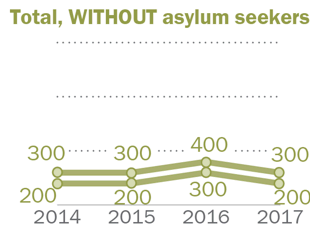
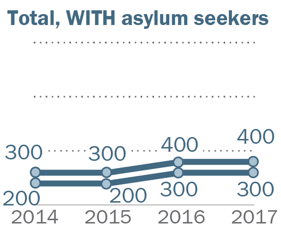
United Kingdom



Italy



France



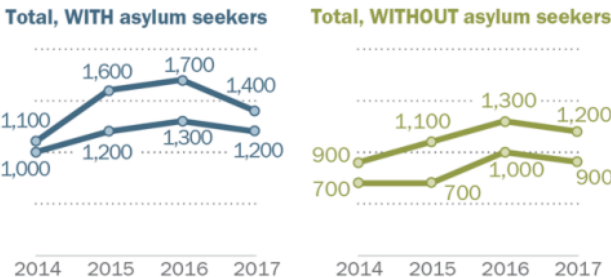
Note: All numbers are rounded; see Methodology for rounding rules. Low and high estimates indicate the range of estimates based on various methodological approaches. Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force survey data. "Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

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Other EU-EFTA countries' estimated unauthorized immigrant population with and without asylum seekers

Range for the estimated number of unauthorized immigrants in thousands living in all European countries combined excluding Germany, the UK, Italy and France, 2014-2017



Note: "Other EU-EFTA countries" include European Union and European Free Trade Association countries excluding Germany, the UK, Italy and France. All numbers are rounded; see Methodology for rounding rules. Low and high estimates indicate the range of estimates based on various methodological approaches.
Source: Pew Research Center estimates based on Eurostat and European labor force survey data.
"Europe's Unauthorized Immigrant Population Peaks in 2016, Then Levels Off"

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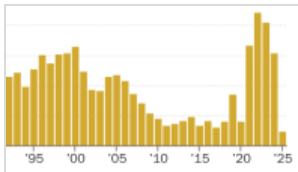


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